

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

SATURDAY, MAY 31, 2025

Without its engine, Nantucket slows after raid

In place ‘run by immigrants,’ many are staying home

By Danny McDonald
GLOBE STAFF

NANTUCKET — It was an unmistakable aspect of the crowd filing off the first ferry of the day shortly after 7 a.m.: tradesmen in construction boots or paint-spattered pants. Some wore sweatshirts advertising HVAC and plumbing services.

Others gripped lunch bags and picked up their toolboxes from checked-baggage containers on a wharf slick with rain. One group chatted in Spanish. They are not here to check out the Nantucket Whaling Museum or to order a \$46 lobster roll. They’re here to work. It’s fair to assume, some locals say, that some in that

crowd are immigrants, a population that represents a linchpin of the island’s economy, and one that has become increasingly fearful under President Trump’s dramatic push to arrest and deport more immigrants. It’s a reality that was brought into sharp relief this week, as federal immigration

authorities arrested about 40 people on Nantucket and Martha’s Vineyard. US Immigration and Customs Enforcement claimed that group included an MS-13 gang member and a child sex offender, but the agency did not release the names of those it detained. The chilling effect of the arrests on aspects of local business was immediate, some say, **NANTUCKET, Page A7**

Win for Trump
The Supreme Court allowed the administration, for now, to revoke a Biden-era program helping immigrants from war-torn countries. **A2.**

Immigrant court dates become a nightmare

Some pleading case to stay find themselves detained by ICE agents in halls

By Giulia McDonnell Nieto del Rio
GLOBE STAFF

On Tuesday afternoon, Mauricio received a frantic call from his wife. Sobbing into the phone, she told him immigration agents had surrounded her after a hearing in immigration court in Boston and taken her into custody. His wife, who arrived in the United States about a year ago after crossing the border and turning herself over to immigration agents, was in court to fight for a chance to stay here legally. Mauricio rushed from work in Cambridge to the John F. Kennedy Federal Building in downtown Boston. As he roamed the empty hallway outside immigration court on the third floor, reality started to sink in: His wife was gone and he had no idea where she was. “They can’t be taking people like that, like they don’t have any rights,” said Mauricio, standing dazed outside the courtroom where his wife appeared before a judge just an hour or so earlier. “We’re all human, and we are trying to do things the right way. We are not hiding.” His wife’s arrest is part of a new concerted effort by the Trump administration to hasten its policy of mass deportations by apprehending people at the very place where they are allowed to plead their case to remain here legally: immigration court. **ICE, Page A7**



The worship team, including Sydney Plosker (center) and pastor Matt Chewning (kneeling), sang at Netcast on a Sunday.

THERE’S SOMETHING DIFFERENT IN STORE

A mini megachurch is packing them in at Liberty Tree Mall



Entry to the main church is through a coffee shop. Hosting 1,000 people on a typical Sunday, Netcast has leased more space.

By Billy Baker
GLOBE STAFF

DANVERS — Imagine you’re walking through the Liberty Tree Mall, making your way from Old Navy toward the AMC Theatre, and you see a storefront with the name Netcast. It looks like a coffee shop, except a sign announces that the coffee is free. Say you don’t attempt to figure out that mystery and continue toward Buffalo Wild Wings. As you look down the corridor to your left, you see it again, that word, Netcast, in big letters above another storefront that looks to be a children’s play area. People guess it’s a co-working space. Maybe a cybercafe with day care? No one ever guesses it’s a church, let alone a church that now fills a huge chunk of the innards of the mall, hosting 1,000 people during two services on a typical Sunday. Its membership is growing so rapidly that Netcast recently leased a third storefront to create overflow seating for people who couldn’t fit into the main church. If you find it weird for a booming “mini” megachurch to **CHURCH, Page A10**

MIT bars class leader from graduation after speech

By Nick Stoico
GLOBE STAFF
and Maria Probert
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

CAMBRIDGE — The president of MIT’s graduating class, Megha Vemuri, was barred from attending the university’s undergraduate commencement Friday, one day after she delivered a speech expressing support for Palestinians in Gaza and criticizing the school’s ties to Israel. **►MIT grads feel hope. B1.** Vemuri was scheduled to be marshal at Friday’s commencement, but earlier in the day was told by MIT chancellor Melissa Nobles that she could not attend the event and that she and her family were banned from campus for most of the day. “You deliberately and repeatedly misled Commencement organizers,” Nobles wrote in an email to Vemuri that was obtained by the Globe. “While we acknowledge your right to free expression, your decision to lead a protest from the stage, disrupting an important institute ceremony, was a violation.” **MIT, Page A10**



Primary care physicians employed by Mass General Brigham overwhelmingly voted to unionize as frustrations mount. **D1.**

Loretta Swit, who played Major Margaret Houlihan for over a decade on M*A*S*H, died at 87. She won two Emmy Awards for the role. **C9.**

Hamas said it was still reviewing a US proposal for a temporary cease-fire in the Gaza Strip. **A4.**

Regie Gibson, a spoken word poet who addresses social and historical themes, will be the state’s inaugural poet laureate. **B1.**

Tomorrow, tomorrow

Saturday: Rain early. High 68-73. Low 52-57.

Sunday: Sunny and breezy. High 64-69. Low 50-55.

Sunrise: 5:10 Sunset: 8:14

Weather and Comics, D4-5. Obituaries, C9.

VOL. 307, NO. 151

* Suggested retail price \$4.00

21610

0 9 4 7 7 2 5 4

‘Elon has pushed the boundaries of his bad behavior more and more.’

PHILIP LOW, a neuroscientist and onetime friend of Musk’s

Reports of heavy drug use fuel questions about Musk

By Kirsten Grind and Megan Twohey
NEW YORK TIMES

As Elon Musk became one of Donald Trump’s closest allies last year, leading raucous rallies and donating about \$275 million to help him win the presidency, he was also using drugs far more intensely than previously known, according to people familiar with his activities. Musk’s drug consumption went well beyond occasional use. He told people he was taking so much ketamine, a powerful anesthetic, that it was affecting his bladder, a known effect of chronic use. He took Ecstasy and psychedelic mushrooms. And he traveled with a daily medication box that held about 20 pills, including ones with the markings of the stimulant Adderall, according to a photo of the box and people who have seen it. It is unclear whether Musk, 53, was taking drugs when he became a fixture at the White House this year and was handed the power to slash the federal bureaucracy. But he has exhibited erratic behavior, insulting Cabinet members, gesturing like a Nazi, and garbling his answers in a staged interview. At the same time, Musk’s family life has grown increasingly tumultuous as he has negotiated his way into the political arena. **MUSK, Page A6**



As Elon Musk entered the political arena, some people who know him expressed concerns about his erratic behavior.